

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 4 2

♥ 10

♦ A 9 5 4 3

♣ 7 6

♠ A K 3

♥ A 7 6 4

♦ 8 6 2

♣ K J 3



♠ 9 8 6

♥ Q J 9 2

♦ K Q J 7

♣ 10 5

♠ 7 5

♥ K 8 5 3

♦ 10

♣ A Q 9 8 4 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♦K. The ♦K holds the trick and East switches to the ♠9.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 1/2 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 2/3

This looks like a walk in the park. Play 2 rounds of trumps, and if they split 3-2 go ahead and force the master trump out. The rest of the tricks would then be yours.

But West shows out on the second trump lead. Ouch!

DO NOT PLAY ANOTHER TRUMP! If you do, then East will pull all the trumps and then West/East will win some ♦s. Many, many ♦s.

Instead just start playing good ♣s. East can ruff in whenever he wants but you will maintain trump control. East can get both master trumps but nothing else.

It is usually correct to leave a master trump undrawn, just let the defender ruff in whenever he wants.

Here that principle applied even though there were **TWO** master trumps out.

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You say 2♣ and partner bids 2♥. What now?

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Again, never mind the ♣ suit. You have an 8-card Major fit and enough points for game, so you bid 4♥.

The contract would be 4♥ played by South.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K Q 3
 ♥ A 7 3
 ♦ Q J 3
 ♣ 10 9 6 3

♠ 8 5 2
 ♥ Q 10 5 2
 ♦ 9 7 4 2
 ♣ K 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 6
 ♥ K 8 4
 ♦ A K 6
 ♣ 7 5 4 2

♠ 10 9 7 4
 ♥ J 9 6
 ♦ 10 8 5
 ♣ A Q J

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1NT	Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

A defender will definitely win this, and probably continue ♠s (but if they switch you would play the same way). You win the ♠ and play another ♣.

South wins and plays another ♠; you win and play another ♣. Deja vu.

South wins again, cashed his established ♠, and exits with a red card. You win and claim the rest of the tricks, including your now-established ♣.

You were able to establish a ♣ because that suit split 3-2.

And you did it without going down because the ♠s split 4-3.

This may seem lucky to you, but don't knock it, it was your **ONLY** chance.

With 12 points and no 4-card Major suit this one is easy. You bid 3NT of course.

The contract would be 3NT played by West.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♠10 and North follows with the ♠2.

Winner List: ♠ = 3 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 8

There is just no way your ninth winner can come from ♠s, ♥s, or ♦s. So by process of elimination you have to get a ♣ trick.

Win the first trick, probably in your hand, and play a ♣.